

Business Communication

Planning for your Bridge Project

Professor Courtney Pierson





Planning for your Capstone Presentation



Developing your Executive Summary and storyboard



Building a persuasive presentation



Delivering an engaging presentation

Everything we do together focuses on getting you ready for next Friday's Capstone Presentation



	Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday	Saturday	Sunday
This week				Class 1: Planning for your Capstone Presentation		Class 2: Developing your Executive Summary ExecSum Labs	ExecSum Labs
Next week	Class 3: Building a persuasive presentation	Class 4: Delivering an engaging presentation		<i>Presentation Rehearsal</i>	<i>Final Capstone Presentation</i>		



Planning for your Capstone Presentation



Developing your Executive Summary and storyboard

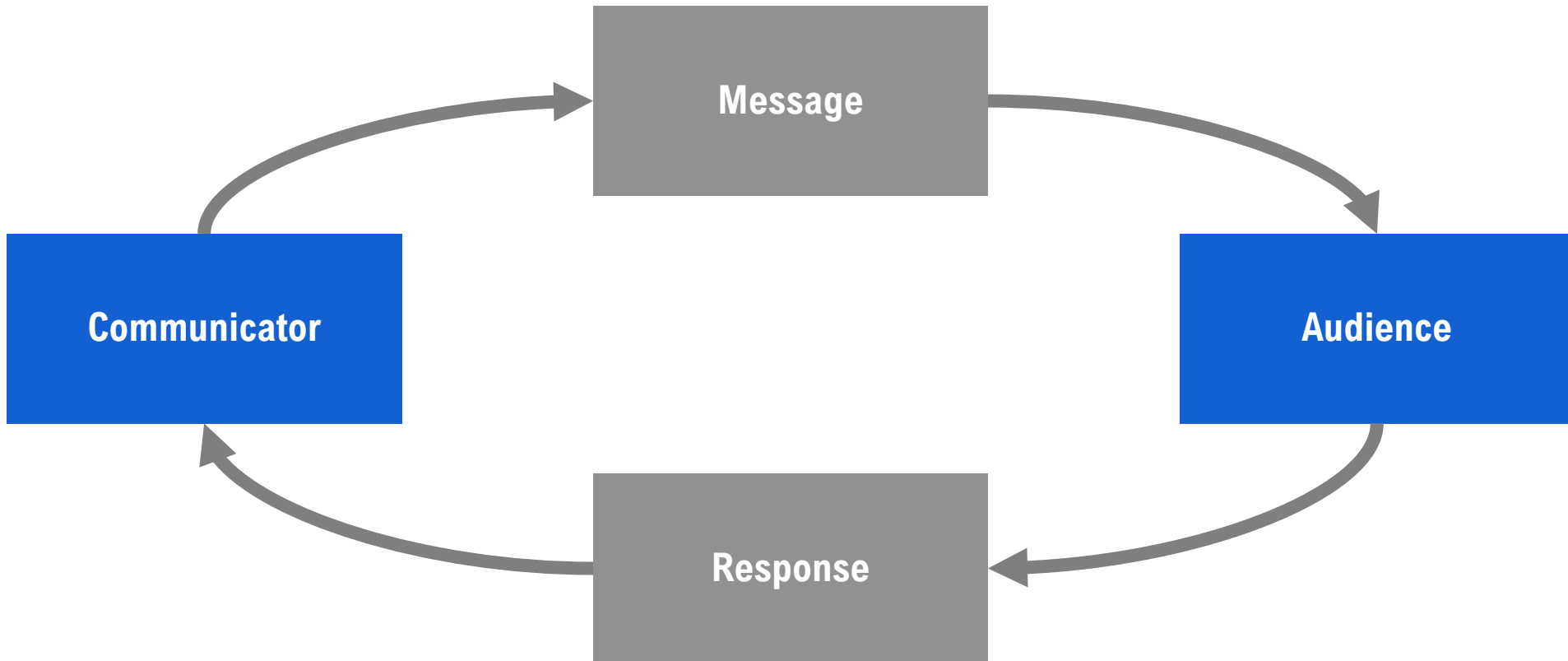


Building a persuasive presentation

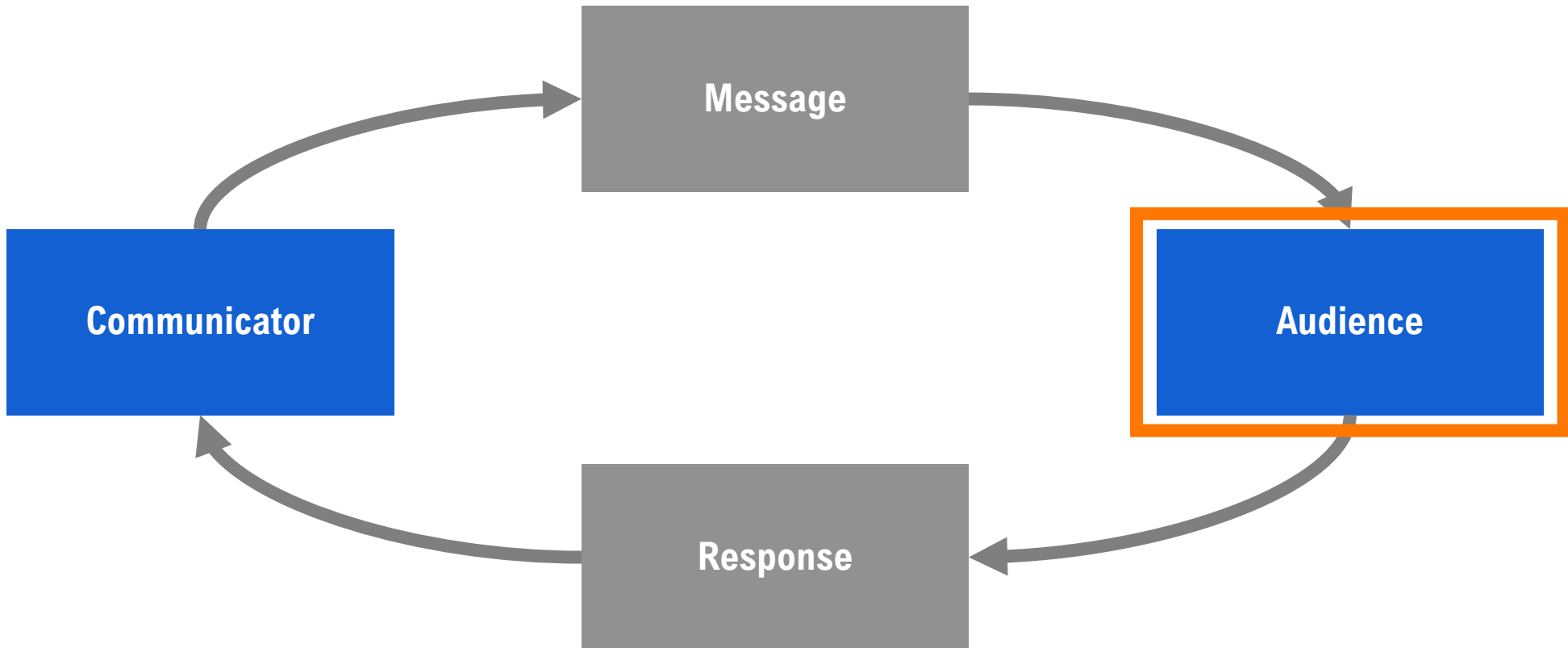


Delivering an engaging presentation

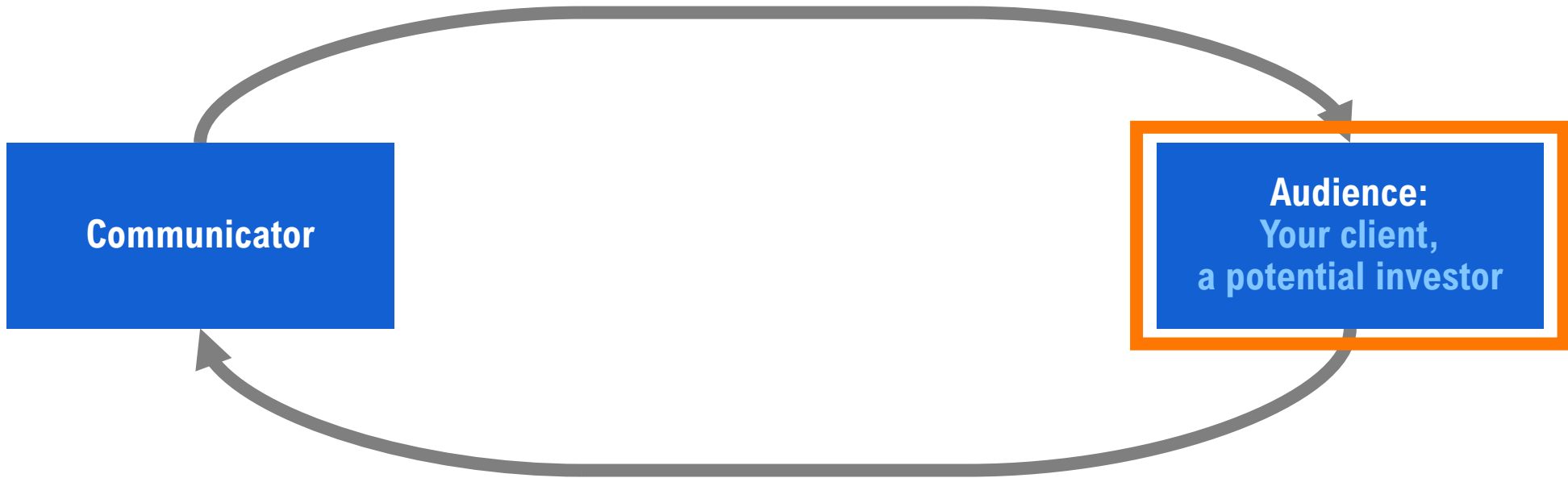
Communication cycle



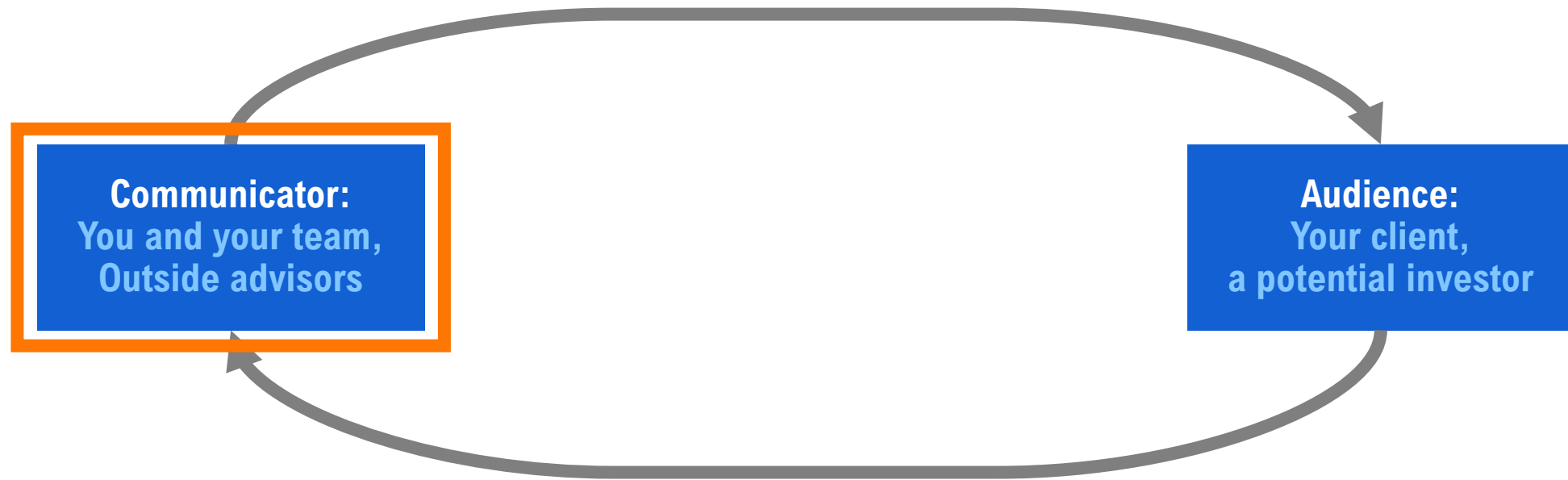
Start with your audience



For the Capstone Presentation, your audience is a private equity investor who buys and sells publicly-traded companies



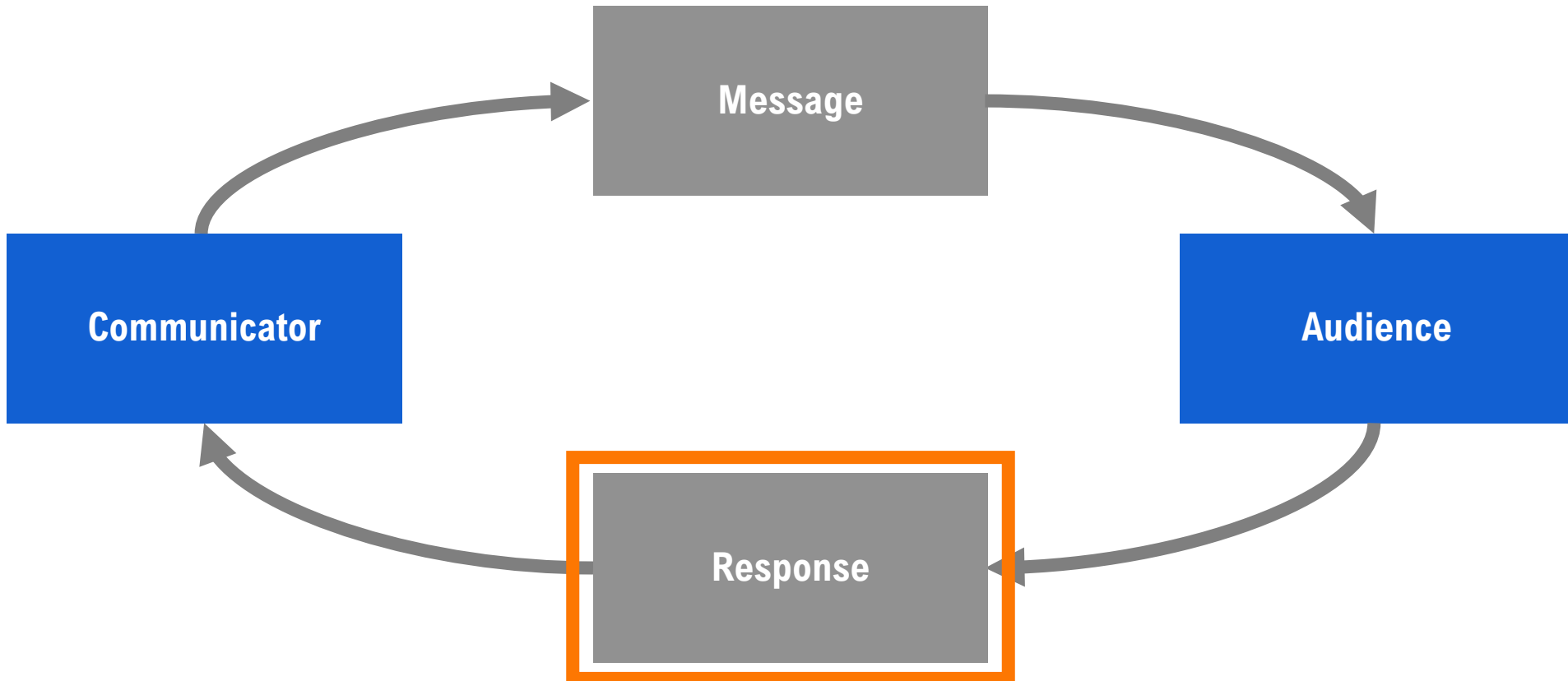
You have been 'hired' as an outside advisor to give an independent assessment of a target company



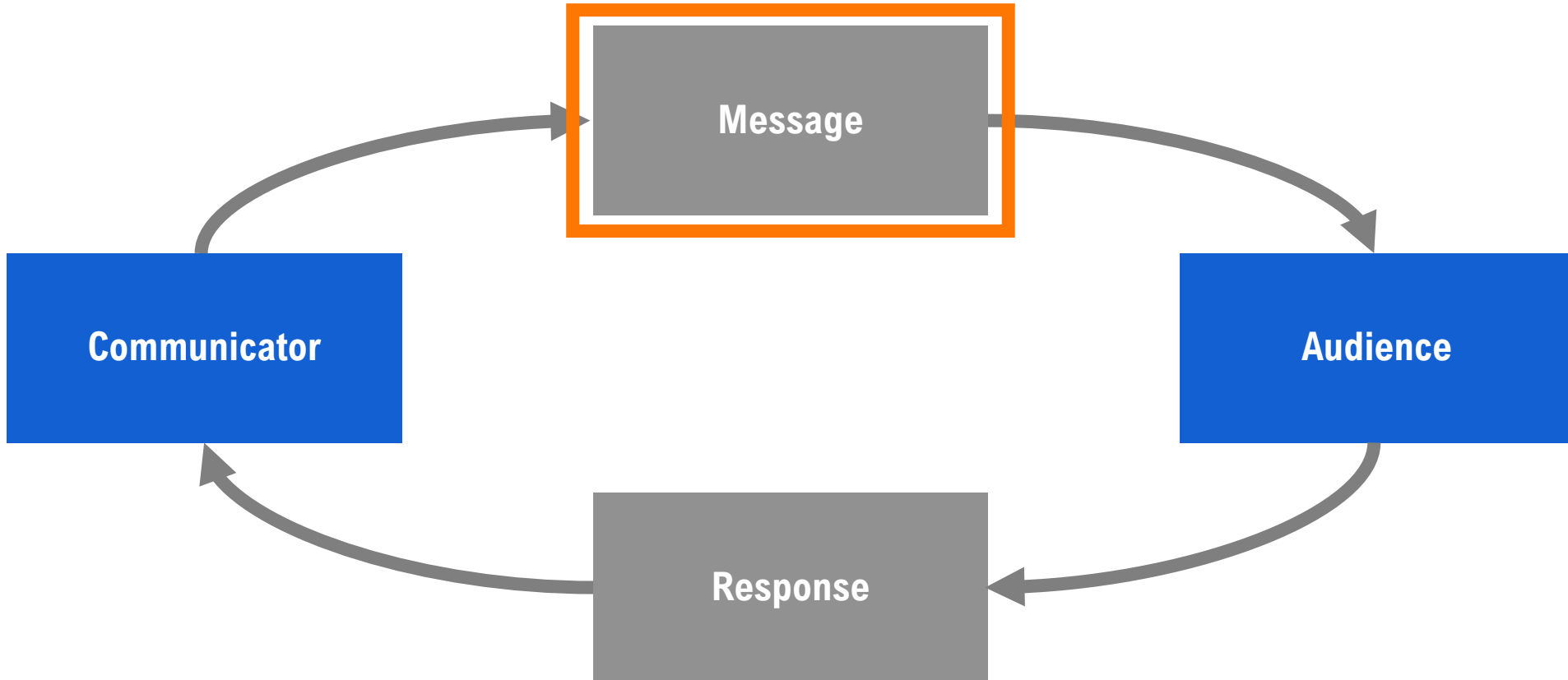
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What does success look like?



How can you appeal to your audience?



Aristotle recommended using a mix of ethos, pathos, and logos



Ethos



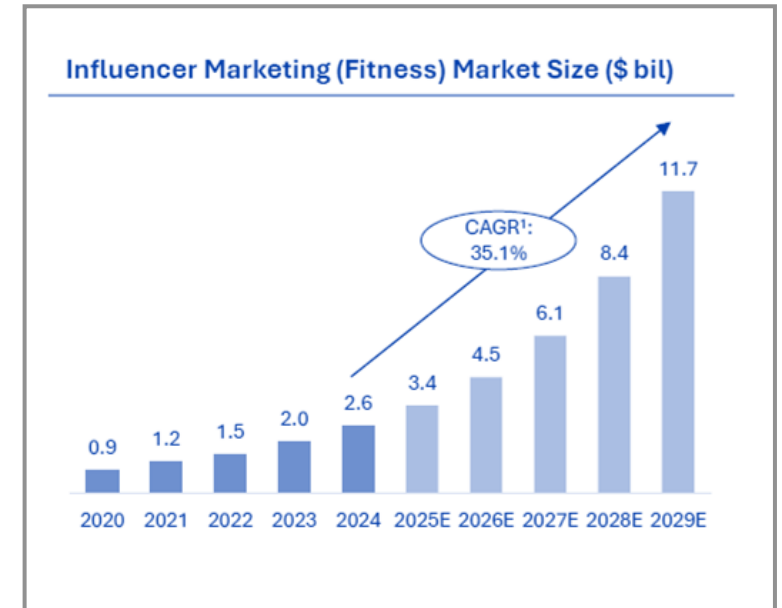
Establish **trust, expertise, and character**. Built through experience, rank, goodwill, association, and common ground.

Pathos



Connect to audience emotions by evoking **feelings** like empathy, pride, or urgency. Built with vivid language, stories or personal anecdotes.

Logos



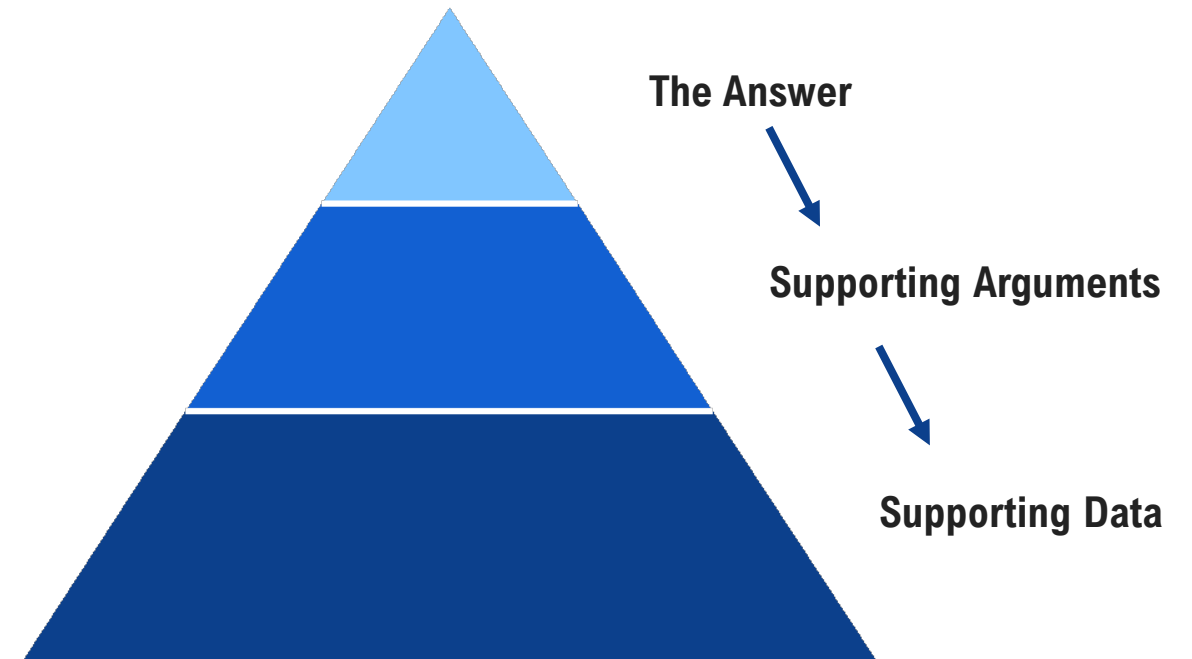
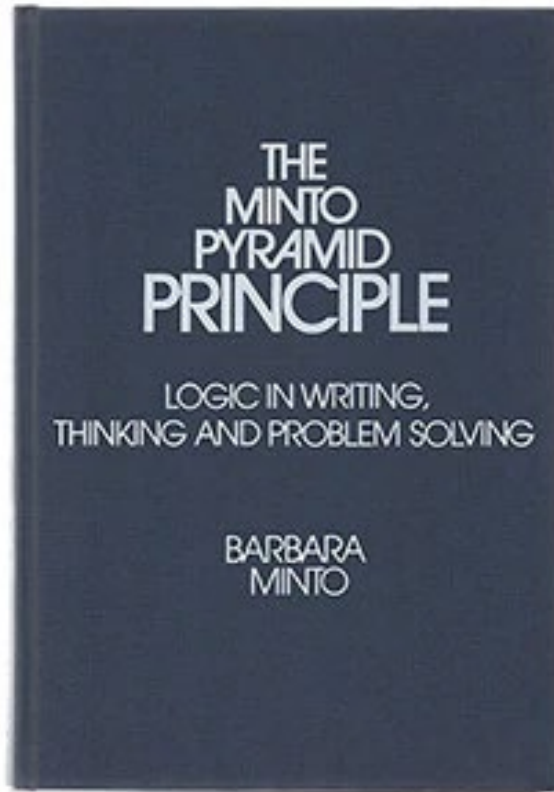
Use **facts, data, examples**, and logical reasoning to make the case compelling and credible.

There are a number of different ways to establish credibility

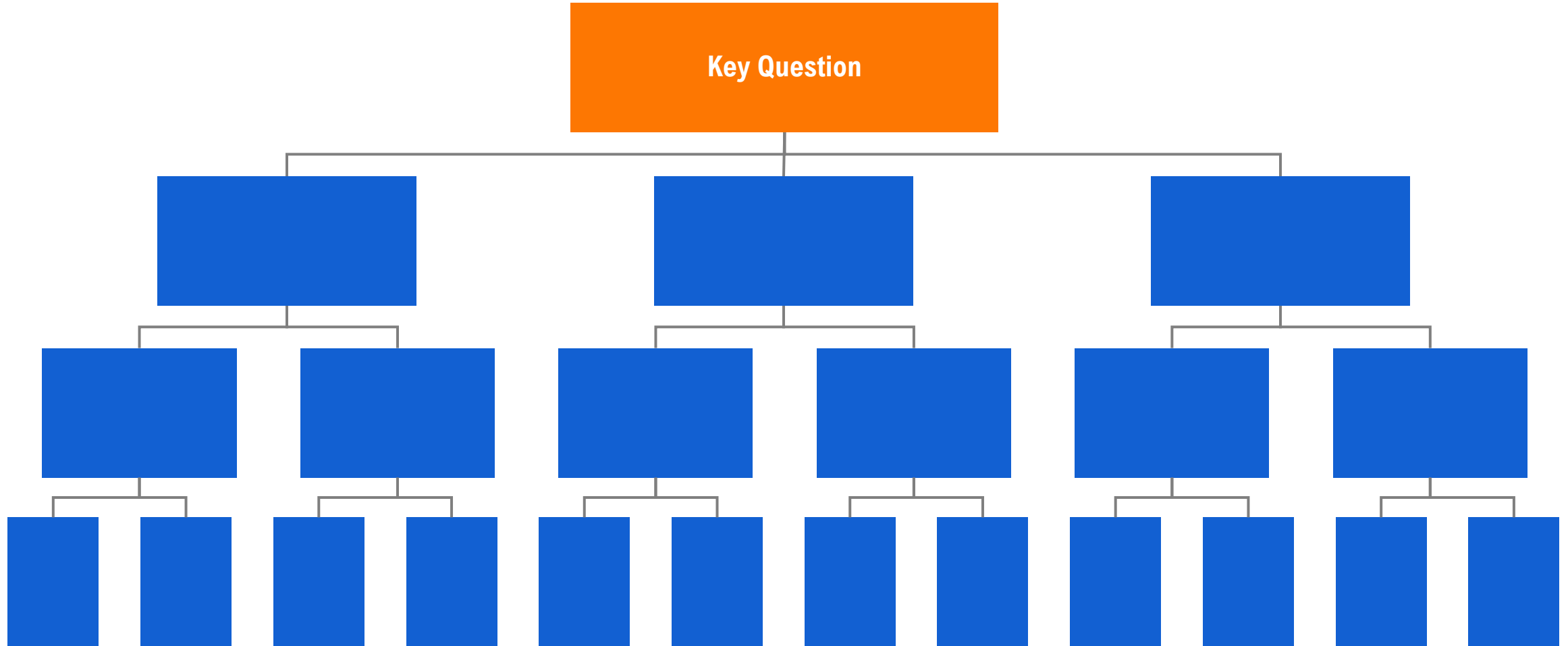


		<i>Initial Credibility</i>	<i>Acquired Credibility</i>
Factor	Based on:	Stress by:	Increase by:
Rank	Hierarchy	Emphasis	Association
Goodwill	Personal relationships	Stress	Audience benefits
Expertise	Background	Emphasis	Association
Image	Attractiveness	Flaunt it!	Audience benefits
Common ground	Shared values	_____ Mention them _____	

The most effective business communicators lead with the answer (consultants call it “Answer First”, in other industries it’s often “BLUF”)



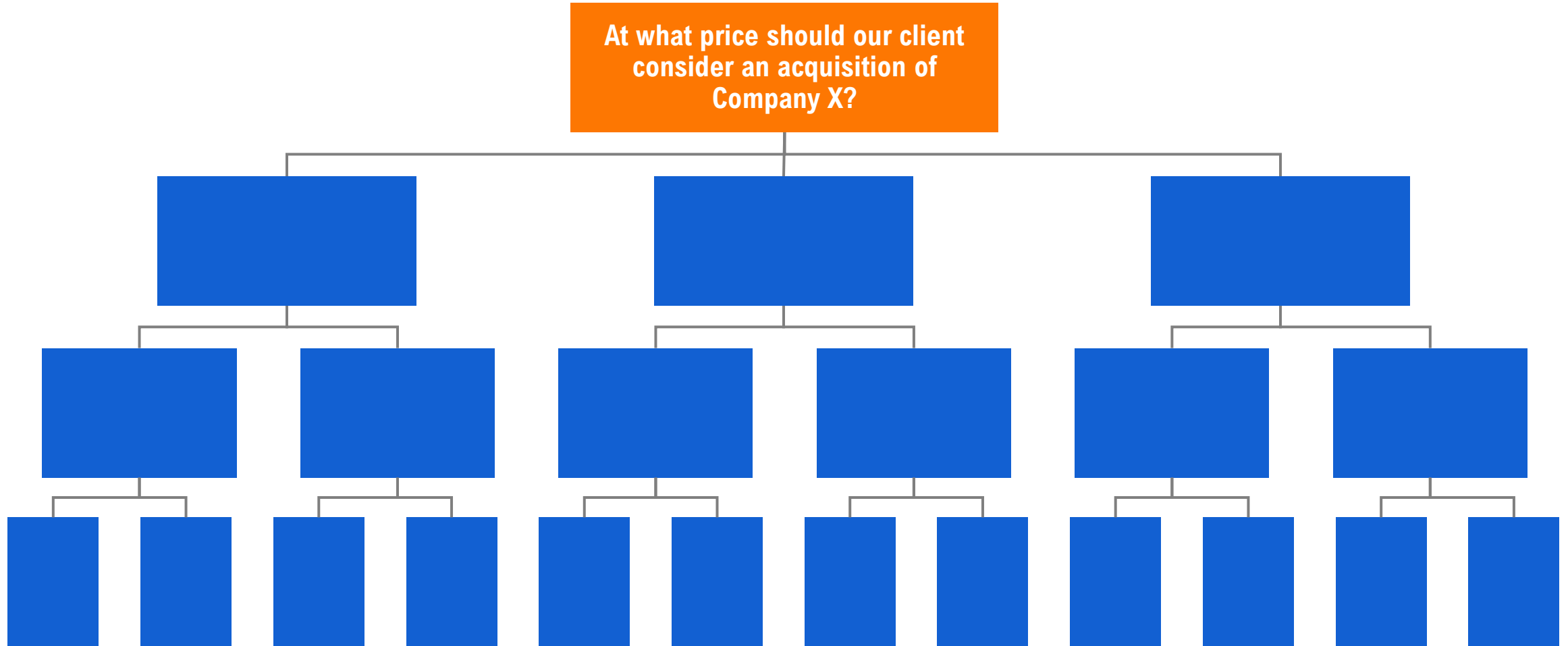
Your argument is only as strong as the question it's built to answer



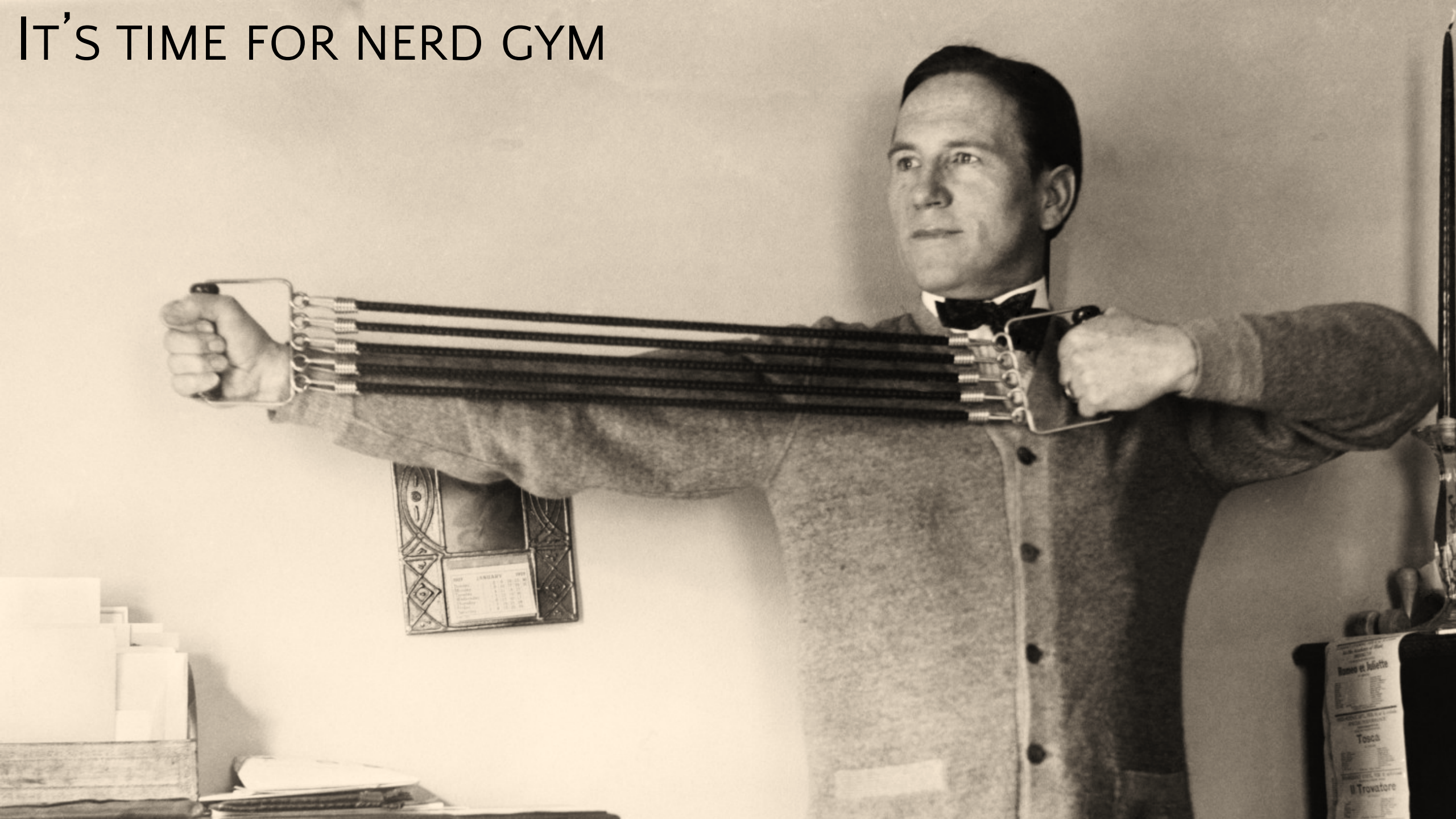


At what price should our client consider an acquisition of Company X?

Start with your audience's question and let the Issue Tree filter what matters



IT'S TIME FOR NERD GYM





At what price should our client consider an acquisition of Company X?

Let's build an Issue Tree for your Capstone Project



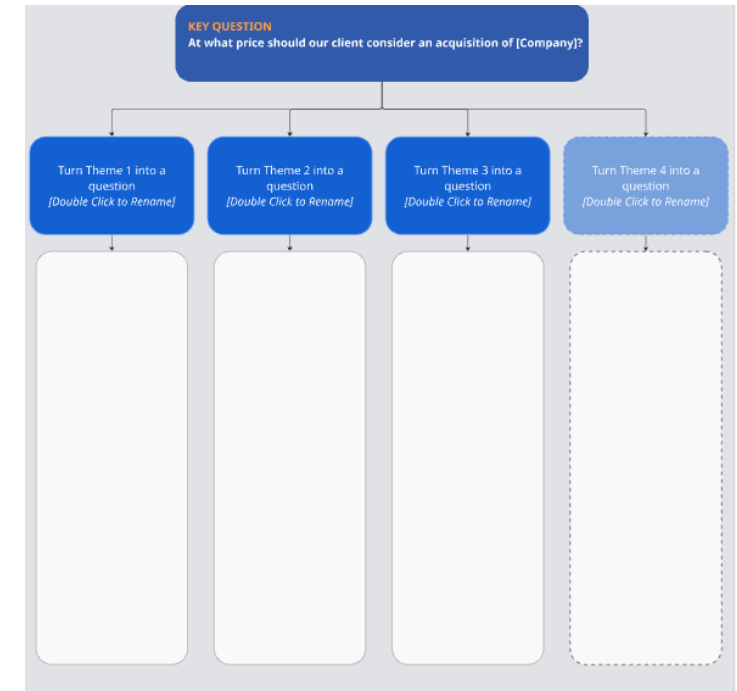
1 Brainstorm

Student 1					
Student 2					
Student 3					
Student 4					
Student 5					

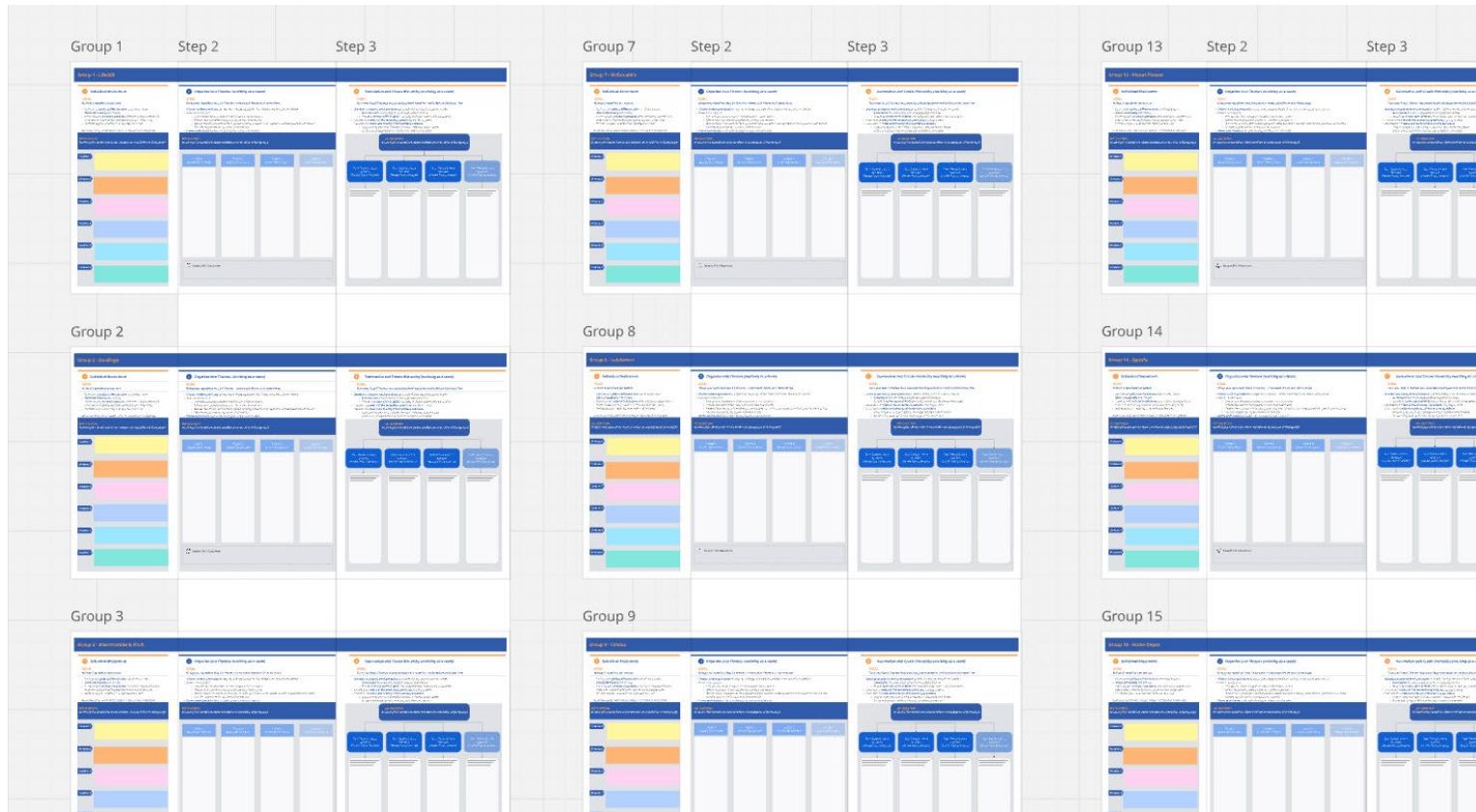
2 Organize

THEME 1 Double Click to Name	THEME 2 Double Click to Name	THEME 3 Double Click to Name	THEME 4 Double Click to Name
Doesn't fit? Place here			

3 Summarize



First some logistics. What is a Miro Board?



- Infinite whiteboard for real-time collaboration
- You will work with your project team
- Link to the Board also available in Canvas

bit.ly/IssueTree-SectionA

Group 1 - Life360**1 Individual Brainstorm****GOAL**

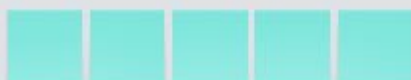
At least 5 questions per person

- Each person **picks a different color** set of sticky notes
- **Work individually** and silently
- Come up with **at least 5 questions** that need to be answered in order answer the Key Question (write one per sticky note)
- No filtering yet -- quantity over quality at this step

Need more sticky notes? select a sticky >> Ctrl/Cmd+D to duplicate

KEY QUESTION

At what price should our client consider an acquisition of [Company]?

Student 1**Student 2****Student 3****Student 4****Student 5****Student 6**

Silent Brainstorm:

*Jot down at least **5 questions you need to answer** in order to determine the fair price for your target company?*

(one question/sticky note)



The next step is to organize those questions into some common themes



1 Brainstorm

2 Organize

3 Summarize

THEME 1 Double Click to Name	THEME 2 Double Click to Name	THEME 3 Double Click to Name	THEME 4 Double Click to Name
 Doesn't fit? Place here			

*Working with your team:
Share your individual
questions and group into
3-4 common themes*



Group 1 - Life360

1 Individual Brainstorm

GOAL

At least 5 questions per person

- Each person **picks a different color** set of sticky notes
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Need more sticky notes? select a sticky => Ctrl/Cmd+D to duplicate

KEY QUESTION

At what price should our client consider an acquisition of [Company]?

Student 1



Student 2



Student 3



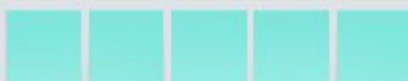
Student 4



Student 5



Student 6



2 Organize into Themes (working as a team)

GOAL

Group your questions into 3-4 themes -- name each theme as it takes shape

- **Cluster similar questions** by copying or dragging stickies from Step 1 into the columns below
- How to run the sort:
 - One person shares a question and moves it into a column
 - Others then add related questions from their brainstorm
 - Repeat the process with another person leading out with a new question until all questions are sorted
 - Use the recycle row for questions that don't fit
- **Name each theme** by double clicking into the column header

KEY QUESTION

At what price should our client consider an acquisition of [Company]?

THEME 1
Double Click to NameTHEME 2
Double Click to NameTHEME 3
Double Click to NameTHEME 4
Double Click to Name

Doesn't fit? Place here

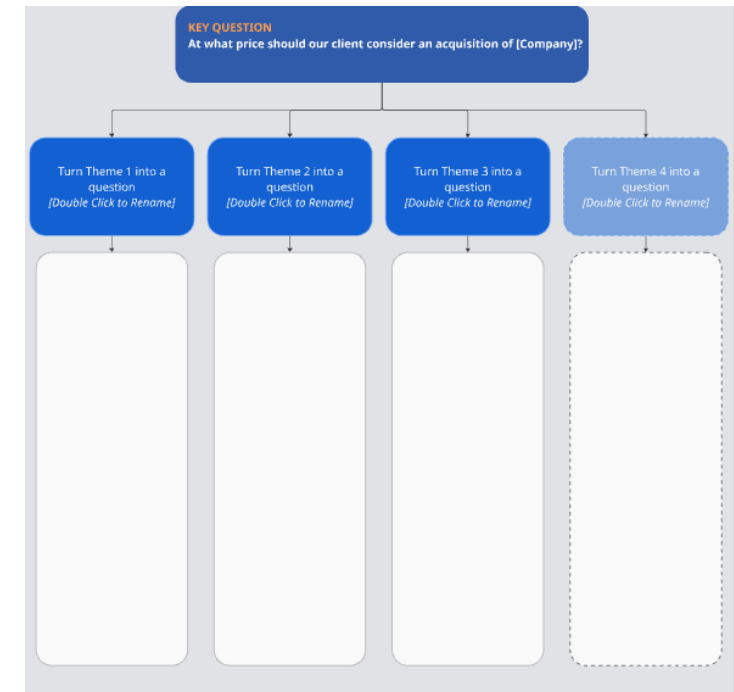
Finally, summarize each theme by writing an overarching question for that column



1 Brainstorm

2 Organize

3 Summarize



Review your secondary questions to confirm they are MECE and in a logical order



Working with your team:

*Turn your themes into a
**set of 3-4 secondary-level
questions.** Check that your
secondary questions are
MECE and the order makes
sense*



Group 1 - Life360

1 Individual Brainstorm

GOAL

At least 5 questions per person

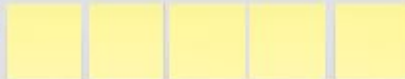
- Each person picks a different color set of sticky notes
- Work individually and silently
- Come up with at least 5 questions that need to be answered in order answer the Key Question (write one per sticky note)
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KEY QUESTION

At what price should our client consider an acquisition of [Company]?

Student 1



Student 2



Student 3



Student 4



Student 5



Student 6



2 Organize into Themes (working as a team)

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Group your questions into 3-4 themes -- name each theme as it takes shape

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 - Repeat the process with another person leading out with a new question until all questions are sorted
 - Use the recycle row for questions that don't fit
- Name each theme by double-clicking into the column header

KEY QUESTION

At what price should our client consider an acquisition of [Company]?

THEME 1
Double Click to Name

THEME 2
Double Click to Name

THEME 3
Double Click to Name

THEME 4
Double Click to Name



Doesn't fit? Place here

3 Summarize and Create Hierarchy (working as a team)

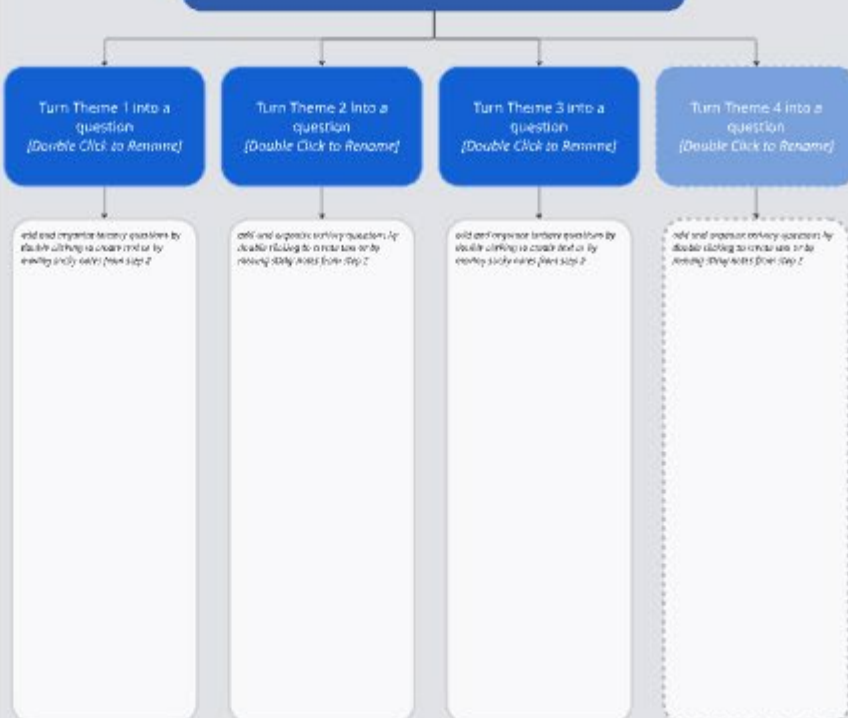
GOAL

Turn your Step 2 Themes into secondary-level questions and build out the Issue Tree

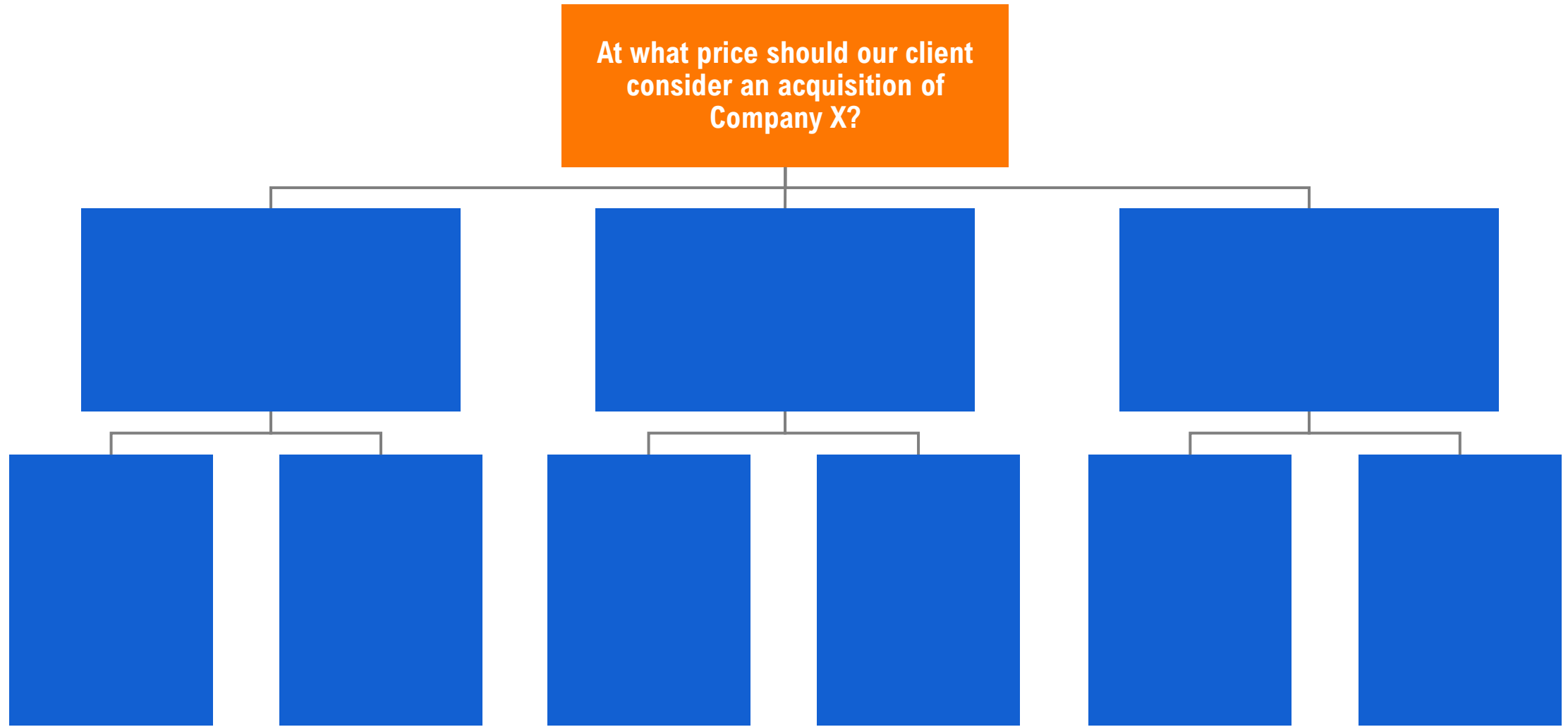
- Develop secondary level questions by double clicking into the column header
 - Summarize the more detailed (tertiary) questions below
 - Should be in the spirit of MECE (mutually exclusive, collectively exhaustive)
- Consider the order of the secondary questions, e.g. big to small
- Consider the order and priority of the tertiary questions
 - Copy or drag your step 2 stickies into their relevant branch boxes
 - Create sub groups within the tertiary questions, as needed

KEY QUESTION

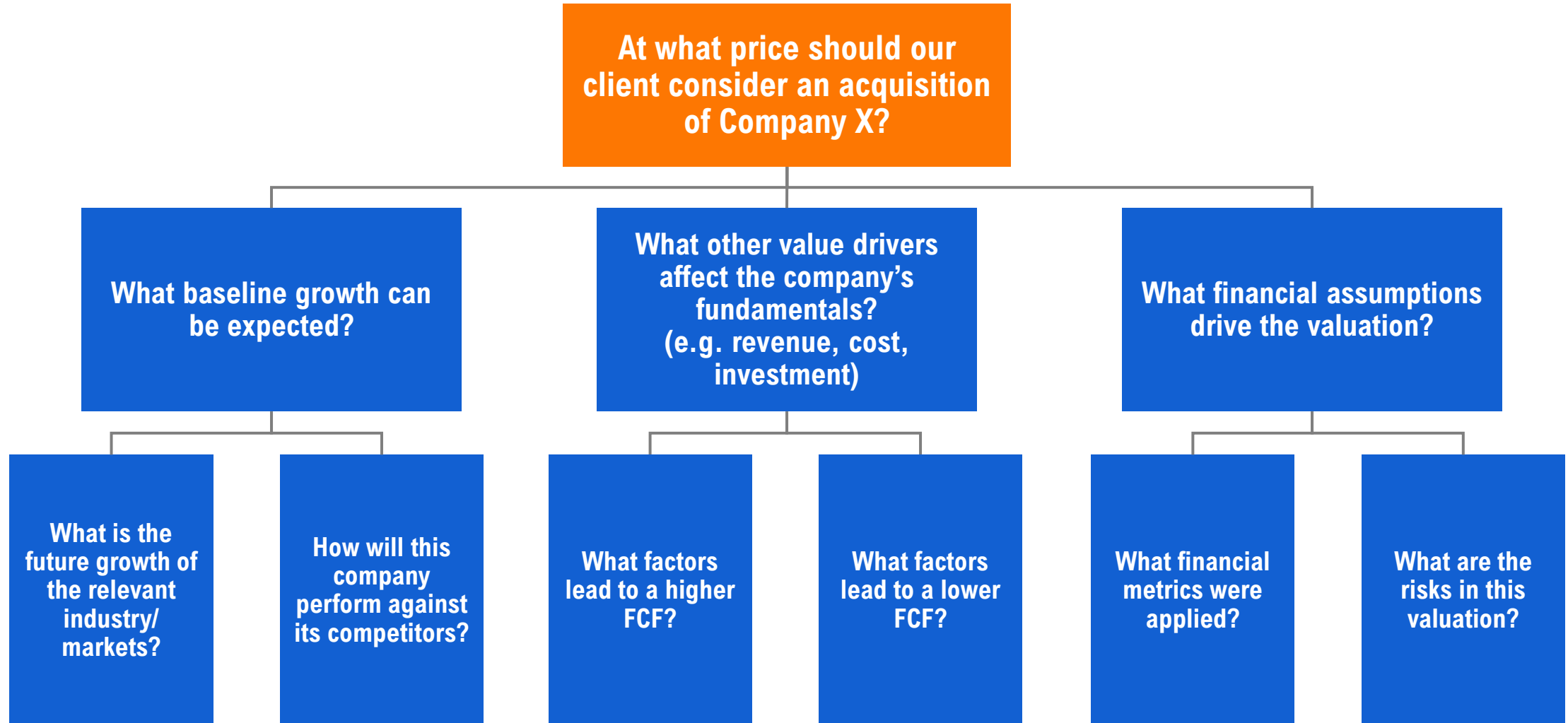
At what price should our client consider an acquisition of [Company]?



What are some of the questions that inform your answer to the Key Question?



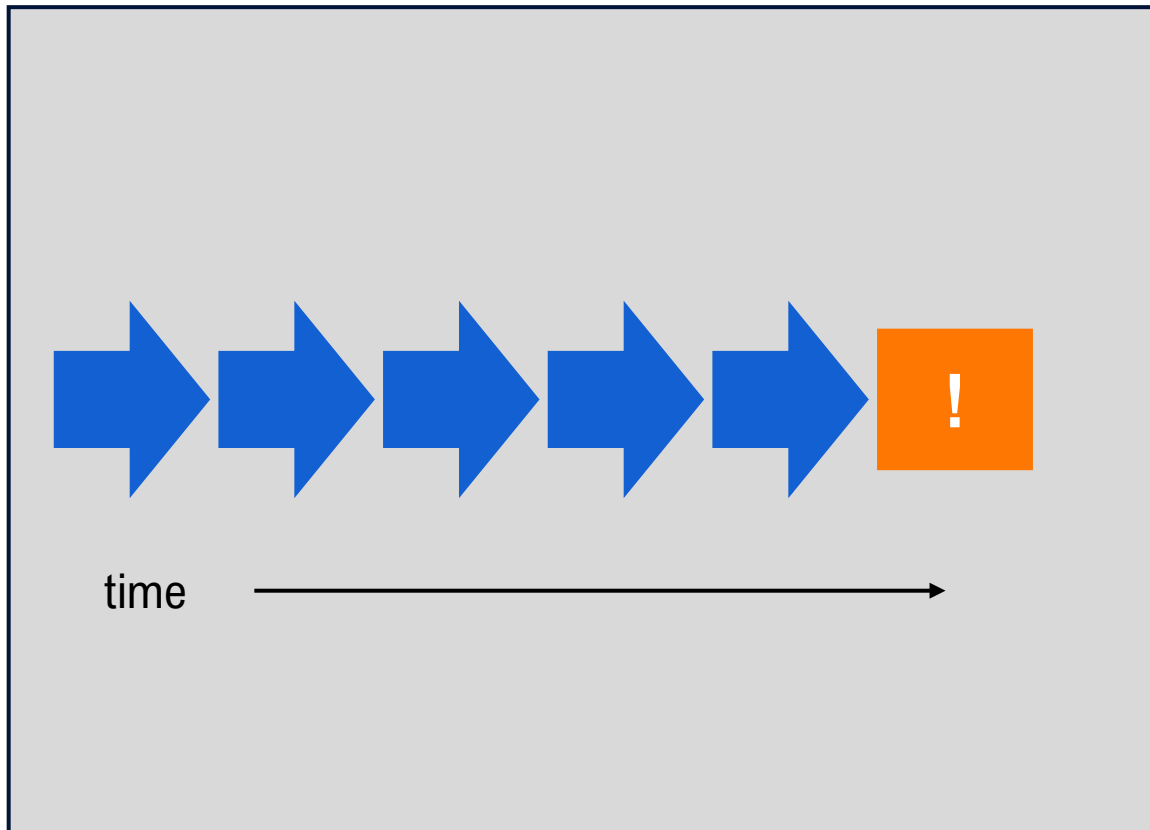
What are some of the questions that inform your answer to the Key Question?



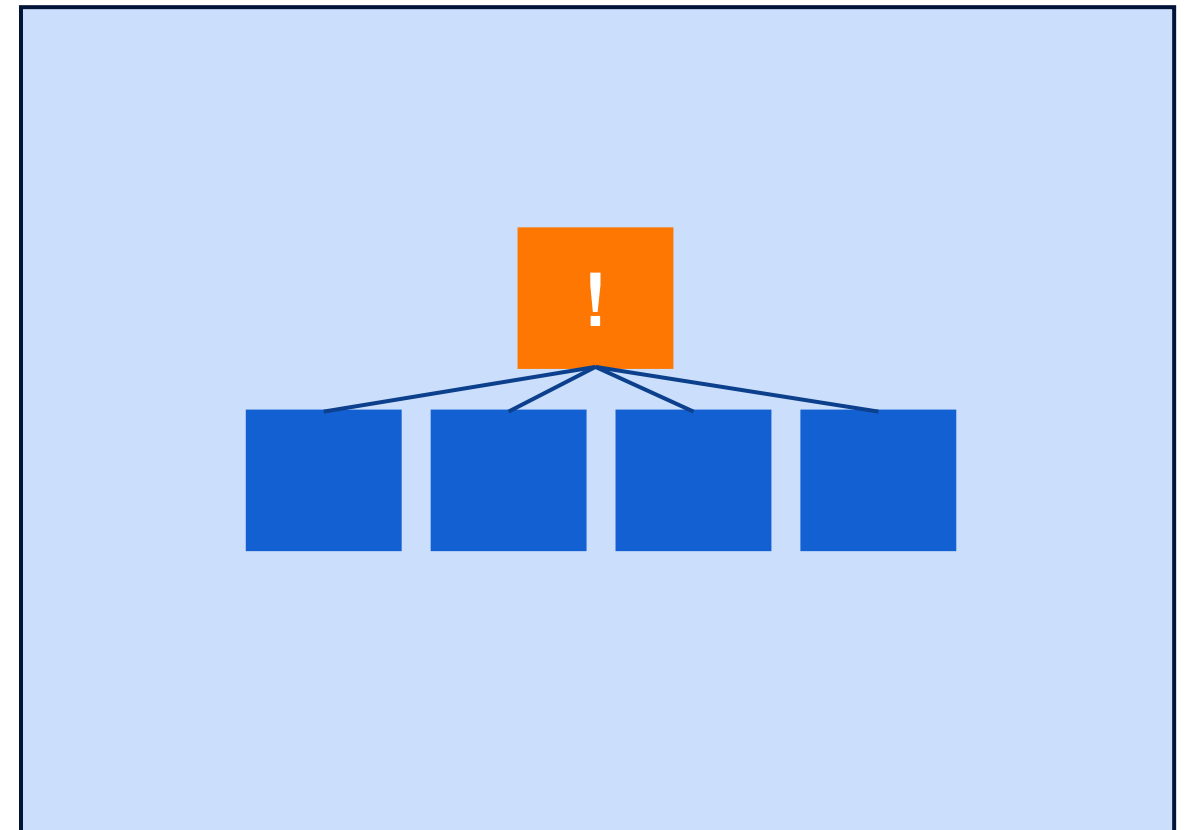
Your investor client cares about what's important in valuing the company, not your learning process



Learning Process



So-What



Your Executive Summary tells a story and outlines your hypothesis at the start of your presentation (Answer First, BLUF)



Recommendation on price written as a whole number



**Value Driver 1
(Baseline Growth)**

Value Driver 2

Value Driver 3

**Over/Fairly/Under
Valued**

The client is expecting to see an Executive Summary that tells the story at the start of your presentation



Recommendation on price written as a whole number

Value Driver 1
(Baseline Growth)

Value Driver 2

Value Driver 3

Over/Fairly/Under
Valued

Your valuation (expressed
in price per share)

The three primary drivers behind
your valuation of the company,
starting with baseline growth

How your valuation
compares to the current
market value



With strong fundamentals and growth potential, Starbucks' fair value is \$96 per share, 28% above its current price

Attractive industry

- The \$160 billion **Global Coffee House** market is growing at 3.6%; **US Quick Service** market at 2.8%
- As the world leader, **Starbucks** has **three times as many stores** as its nearest competitor

Differentiated position

- Across all its markets, Starbucks is recognized as a leader, providing best-in-class **product quality** and **customer experience**
- As a result, Starbucks has captured **36% market share** in the U.S.

Promising expansion opportunities

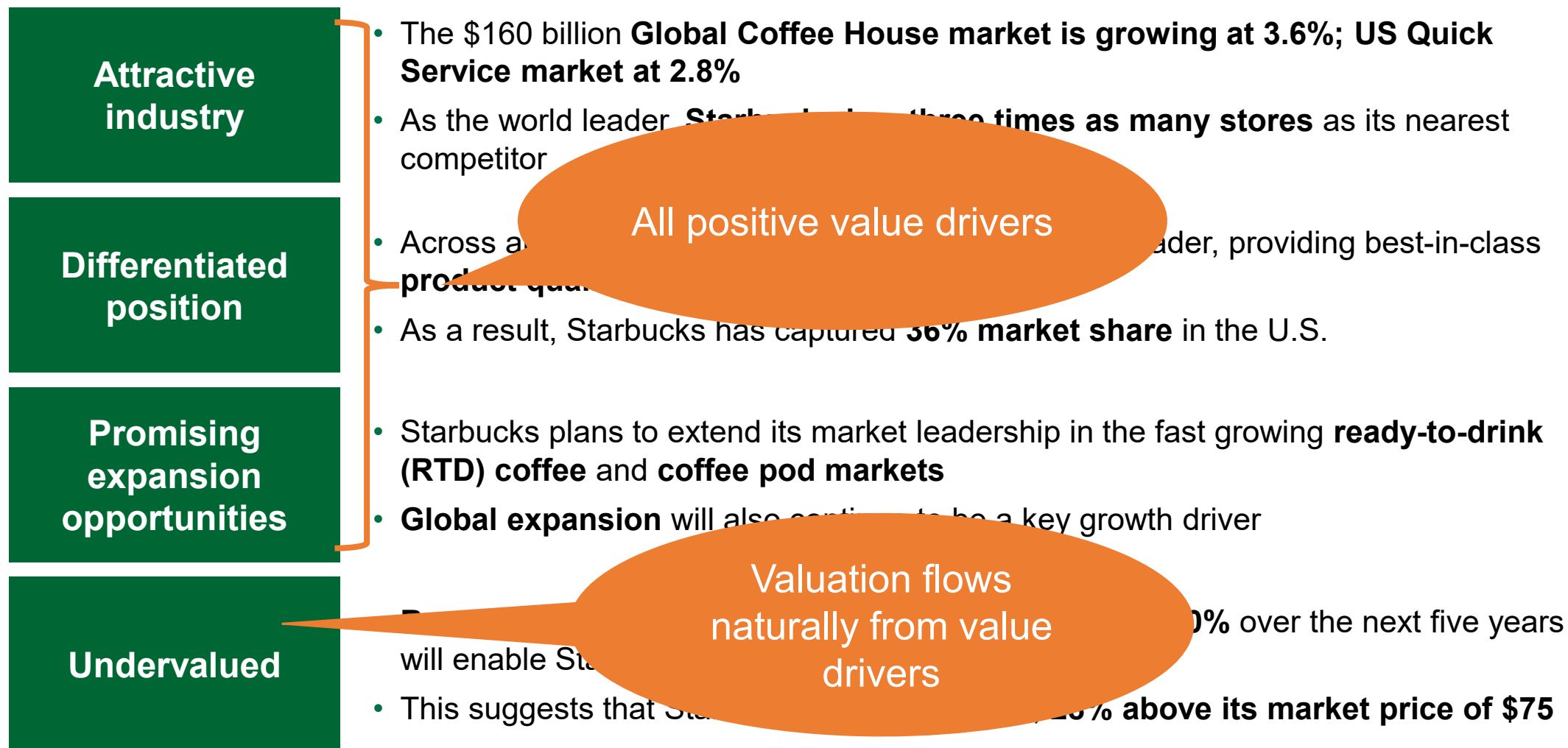
- Starbucks plans to extend its market leadership in the fast growing **ready-to-drink (RTD) coffee** and **coffee pod markets**
- **Global expansion** will also continue to be a key growth driver

Undervalued

- **Revenue growth of ~7.3% p.a.** and **cost growth of ~8.0%** over the next five years will enable Starbucks to achieve a \$113B valuation
- This suggests that Starbucks fair value is \$96, **28% above its market price of \$75**



With strong fundamentals and growth potential, Starbucks' fair value is \$96 per share, 28% above its current price



Despite recent growth, due to uncertainty and market trends, On should be valued at \$28, 48% below current market value



Stable Growing Industry

- Industry outlook for lifestyle and performance footwear remains positive
- The global footwear market is projected to grow by **3.95% CAGR** from 2025 to 2029
- Shifting consumer preferences are opening **new market segments** with growth spread across many players

Small Market Share

- On holds **limited market share** in a crowded field
- Dominant players like **Nike and Adidas** control nearly 50% of the market
- Sustaining On's rapid growth will be increasingly difficult against entrenched competitors
- Smaller companies are disproportionately affected by **tariffs**

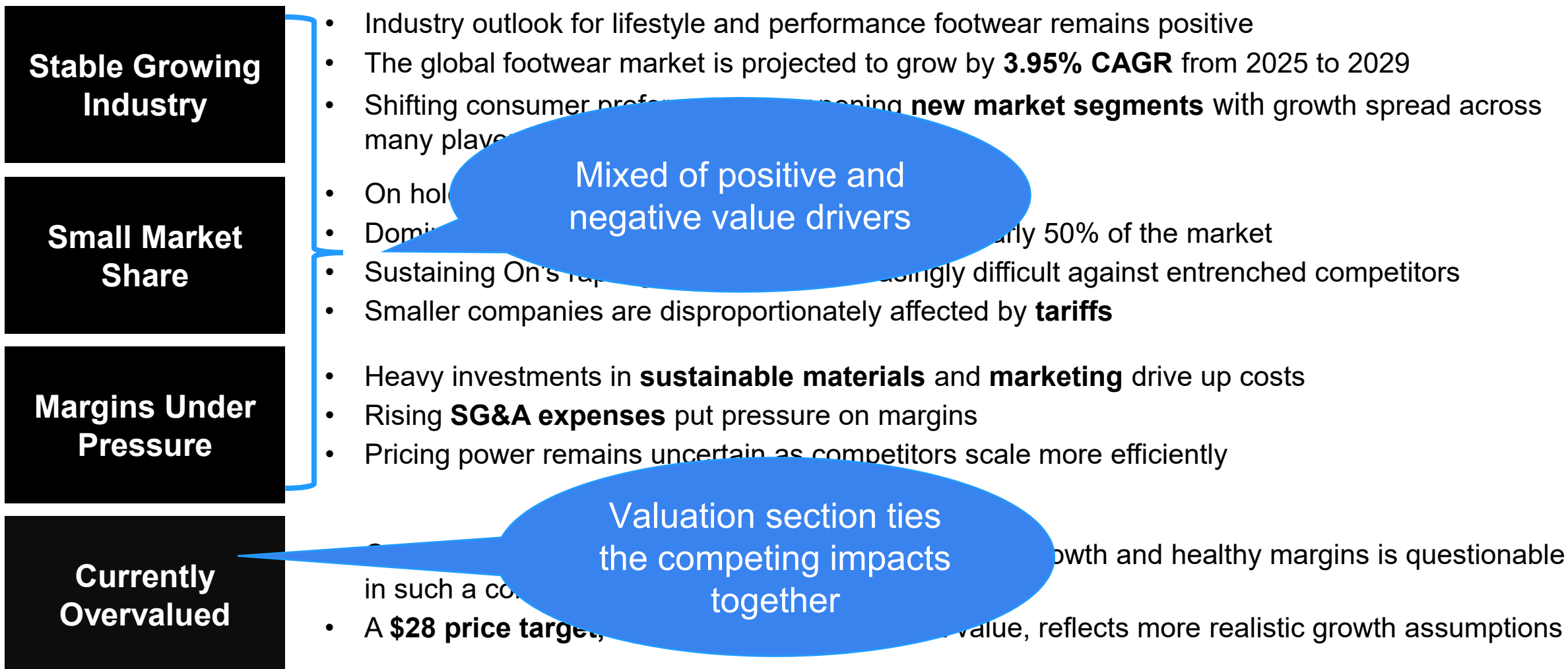
Margins Under Pressure

- Heavy investments in **sustainable materials** and **marketing** drive up costs
- Rising **SG&A expenses** put pressure on margins
- Pricing power remains uncertain as competitors scale more efficiently

Currently Overvalued

- On's ability to **differentiate**, as well as maintain high growth and healthy margins is questionable in such a competitive space
- A **\$28 price target, 48% below** current market value, reflects more realistic growth assumptions

Despite recent growth, due to uncertainty and market trends, On should be valued at \$28, 48% below current market value



Despite rapid growth and brand optimism, CAVA's fair value is \$20 per share, 77% below its current price



EMERGING BRAND IN COMPETITIVE MARKET

- CAVA has carved out a distinctive Mediterranean niche within the **\$45.6B fast-casual restaurant market**, which is **projected to grow at a 5.8% CAGR** through 2034
- With an **NPS of 62**, CAVA resonates with consumers; however, their brand reputation and menu are likely temporary advantages

RAPID EXPANSION RISKS

- CAVA's strong unit economics support an ambitious plan to more than **double its store count to 1,000 locations by 2032**
- Achieving that pace introduces compounding **execution risk**, and **CapEx** is projected to consume nearly a quarter of revenue by 2028

MARKET VOLATILITY

- Despite record Q1 2025 revenue of \$328M (+28% YoY), CAVA's stock fell 23%, suggesting **growth expectations may already be priced in**
- With a **P/E of 148x** versus Chipotle's 47x, CAVA's growth story appears disconnected from its peer benchmarks

CURRENTLY OVERVALUED

- Our DCF yields a fair value of \$20/share, a 77% discount to the current price, under **conservative but well-supported assumptions**
- Justifying CAVA's **current price requires a 70% revenue CAGR** through 2029, three times our base case and **beyond any comparable fast-casual precedent**

Despite rapid growth and brand optimism, CAVA's fair value is \$20 per share, 77% below its current price

EMERGING BRAND IN COMPETITIVE MARKET	– CAVA has carved out a distinctive Mediterranean niche within the \$45.6B fast-casual restaurant market, which is projected to grow at a 5.8% CAGR through 2034 – With an NPS of 62, CAVA resonates with consumers; however, their brand reputation and menu are likely temporary
RAPID EXPANSION RISKS	– CAVA's 1,000 stores, with 100 new openings in 2024, plan to more than double its store count to 2,000 by 2028 – Achieving that pace carries execution risk, and CapEx is projected to consume nearly a quarter of revenue by 2028
MARKET VOLATILITY	– Despite record Q1 2025 revenue of \$328M (+28% YoY), CAVA's stock fell 23%, suggesting growth expectations may already be priced in – With a P/E of 148x versus Chipotle's 47x, CAVA's growth story appears disconnected from its peer benchmarks
CURRENTLY OVERVALUED	– Our DCF yields a fair value of \$20 per share, 77% below the current price, under conservative assumptions – Justifying CAVA's current price requires a 3x increase in revenue through 2029, three times our base case and beyond any reasonable expectation

Value drivers emphasize risk and downside

Impact of these issues on valuation

On Saturday, we'll focus on your Executive Summary and storyboard



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